

Discussion of
“The Green Transition and Job in the MENA”
by AlAzzawi and Hlasny

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Overview

Question

What is the prevalence & determinants of Green Jobs in MENA?

⇒ Aim: Identify winners & losers from Green Transition.

Contribution

No work on the region

Data

Labor Market Panel Surveys for:

Egypt ('18), Jordan ('16), Tunisia ('14), Palestine (LFS-'20)

Research Design

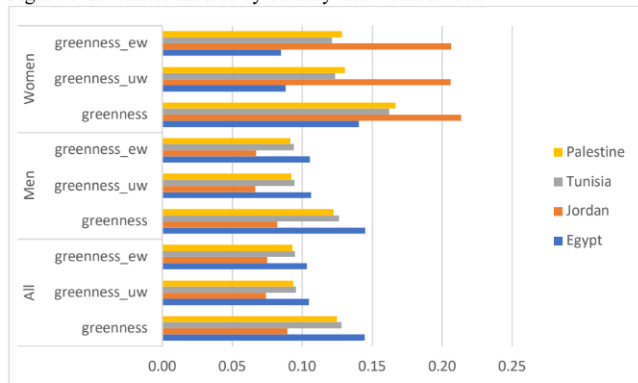
Index for how green-skilled a job based on Vona et al. (2019)

Main Result

- (1) Very little Green jobs in all countries ($\leq 15\%$ relative to all jobs)
- (2) Women more represented in Green Jobs (except in Egypt)
- (3) Trivial difference between old and young workers in Greenness score.

Prevalence of Green Jobs

Figure 1 Greenness indices by country and workers' sex



Source: Authors' calculations based on ELMPS 2018, JLMPS 2016, TLMPs 2014 and Palestine LFS 2020.

Green Transition in economies at-risk of climate change?

The classification of jobs is based on Green skills in US jobs.

These economies are very different and green transition might feature a lot of climate risk-mitigation efforts.

Are climate risk mitigation tasks in jobs included in this skill set?

Other Comments

- Pitch: paper takes green transition as exogenous and explores risk/rewards to LM from its adoption.
 - S: Endogenous process where govts won't move towards sustainability except if LM market risks are mitigated. Hence, these risks/rewards are likely to govern speed/extent of transition.
- Method: Classifying green jobs is based on fraction of green skills from a US database of job descriptions (O*NET).
 - I: Are the tasks done (technologies deployed) by an accountant in the US the same as the tasks done by an accountant in Egypt? What about construction?
- Do (sectoral) commitments by govt. to Green Transition lead to changes in Green Jobs index in those sectors
 - S: This could give a neat DiD design with some sectors treated and other not.
- Over time, did the Green score increase in the countries studied?